



MUSIC IN BOSHAM

SUNDAY 4TH OCTOBER, 6PM

HOLY TRINITY CHURCH

Chichester Chamber Ensemble



Bogdan Văcărescu • Violin
Professor Laura Ritchie • Cello
Ben Lathbury • Piano

ADMISSION FREE • DONATIONS ACCEPTED

PROGRAMME

Piano Trio No.2 in E flat major, D 929

F. Schubert (1797-1828)

I. Allegro

II. Andante con moto

III. Scherzo: Allegro moderato

IV. Allegro moderato

MEET THE ARTISTS

Bogdan Văcărescu

Violin

Bogdan Văcărescu is a Romanian-born concert violinist based in the UK.

He has toured internationally since his teens, performing at venues including the Sydney Opera House, the Athenaeum in Bucharest, the Romanian National Radio Hall, The United Nations Concert Hall in New York, New Morning in Paris, Kings Place and the Southbank Centre in London.

He has made numerous recordings for Romanian National Radio and Television, BBC Radio and ABC Australia, and has performed solo violin on soundtracks for films and documentaries, collaborating with award-winning composer Andy Hopkins, Oscar-winning composers Stephen Warbeck and Gabriel Yared, as well as productions for BBC and ABC Television.

A regular guest on BBC Radio 6 Music with Cerys Matthews, Bogdan performed the solo violin for *The Master and Margarita* by Mikhail Bulgakov for BBC Radio, collaborating with director Sasha Yevtushenko and composer Stephen Warbeck. He later composed the music for *The Glass Menagerie* by Tennessee Williams for Drama on 3, continuing his collaboration with Yevtushenko.

He toured internationally for many years with the comedy-cabaret string quartet Graffiti Classics, before spending five years leading his Balkan band, Paprika.

His album, “Violin and Piano Thrillers” with renowned British pianist Julian Jacobson, was named Album of the Year in Romania and received a five-star review in Musical Opinion. It features Enescu’s Sonata no. 2 in F minor followed by virtuosic gems rarely performed since Heifetz. New projects include a collaboration with Bulgarian pianist Valentina Seferinova.

As founder and artistic director of “String Dimensions” he champions beautiful chamber music that is rarely heard in today’s concert halls or on radio programmes.



With Unicorn Frequency he explores and reimagines Hungarian folk, Romanian laments and showpieces, Bulgarian dances, Russian Romani music, Italian pizzicas and tarantellas and Griko tunes, alongside free improvisation, jazz and unique arrangements of masterpieces from the classical repertoire.

Bogdan is currently an associate lecturer at the University of Chichester where he teaches violin.

Bogdan is a graduate of the Music Conservatory in Bucharest and the Royal Academy of Music in London as a student of Beno Schwartzman, Paul Ratz and Gyorgy Pauk.

Professor Laura Ritchie, Cello

Cello

Professor Laura Ritchie is Professor of Learning and Teaching at the University of Chichester Conservatoire. She is vibrant in her teaching, research, music-making, and in life.

Laura's musical background is as a classical cellist, originally training in Chicago with Hans Jensen before coming to the UK to pursue her Master's degree and PhD at the Royal College of Music. As a musician Laura spans genres and has performed both as a classical recitalist and as a member of The Mummers on Jools Holland and at Glastonbury.

Besides being a cellist, Laura is a Chartered Psychologist and her recent book *Yes I Can: Learn to use the Power of Self-efficacy* (2021) is a practical and personal book about self-beliefs and noticing possibilities in our everyday lives to adopt a real sense of 'yes'. Laura's enthusiasm is contagious and inspires people to realize their goals through positive achievement and reach beyond their dreams.



Ben Lathbury

Piano

Ben Lathbury is an award-winning musician, originally from Staffordshire. Following early success in numerous competitions, Ben moved to West Sussex in 2006 to study at the University of Chichester Conservatoire, where he established himself as a pianist of considerable talent.

In 2009, Ben received a scholarship to fund his Master's degree in Music Performance, studying with international pianist Jonathan Plowright. Since its completion, Ben has won numerous competitions, given dozens of solo recitals and has appeared as a special guest soloist with orchestras across the UK. He has been recognised as a champion of 20th century American repertoire; his interpretation of Leroy Anderson's *Concerto in C* garnered critical acclaim and his performances of Gershwin's *Rhapsody in Blue* earned him a nomination for Best Classical Act in the Guide Awards and have been hailed as "magnificent".

In addition to his talent as a pianist, Ben is widely respected as a choral conductor, organist, singer and teacher. He is Director of Music at Holy Trinity Church in Bosham, Musical Director for a number of local choral groups, and founder and Artistic Director of the Music in Bosham recital series. He was a founder teacher of Chichester Free School, where he taught as Head of Performing Arts for four years and has also taught at the University of Chichester Conservatoire as an associate lecturer in piano.

Ben's day job as a software engineer for an entertainment technology company complements his music career nicely, and in his spare time, he enjoys running, theatre and quizzes.



Many thanks for supporting this evening's performance. We hope that you enjoyed your time at Holy Trinity Church and look forward to seeing you again.

NEXT PERFORMANCE

Music in Bosham returns on Sunday 1st November at 6pm.

For further information on *Music in Bosham* events, or for any other enquiries or comments, please visit our website:

musicinbosham.com